

## Investigation Report - Ticket #CS-0251

### Incident Report

**Title:** Proxy - Large Data Transfers Detected (Possible Data Exfiltration)

**Detection Source:** Proxy Logs, DLP (Data Loss Prevention) Investigation

**Detection Time:** March 14, 2025, 21:29

**Severity:** High

**Category:** Insider Threat – Unauthorized Data Transfer

**Status:** Closed

### Incident Summary

On March 14, 2025, the SOC team detected two large file uploads by user [REDACTED] to dropbox.com, a file storage platform. The uploads, totaling 106,700 bytes, were executed using the PUT method from the corporate network, which raised a red flag for potential data exfiltration. The user initially claimed the upload was unintentional and contained personal event photographs. However, a subsequent DLP investigation, including steganography analysis on the images inside Data.zip, confirmed that **confidential business data was covertly embedded in the image files**. This incident is a confirmed case of **intentional data exfiltration** and is classified as a **True Positive (Insider Threat)** with a **High business impact**.

### URL & Domain Reputation Analysis

- **Domain:** dropbox.com
- **Reputation:** Legitimate cloud-based file storage service.
- **Risk Factor:** Commonly exploited for exfiltration due to easy access and encryption support.

### Impacted User & System

- **User:**
- **Designation:** Employee Relations Manager
- **Department:** HR

- **User Clarification:** Initially claimed the file upload was unintentional and contained personal event photographs.
- **Source IP:**
- **Destination IP:**
- **Domain:** dropbox.com
- **Web Category:** File Storage/Sharing

## Proxy & DLP Log Analysis

- **Proxy Log Details:**
  - **Initial Access:** At 21:27, the user made a GET request to the Dropbox login page, followed by a POST request to enter credentials, both receiving a 200 OK response.
  - **File Upload Activity:**
    - **First Upload:** At 21:29, a PUT request transferred 51,200 bytes of data (a ZIP file) with a 100 informational response.
    - **Second Upload:** At 21:33, a second PUT request transferred an additional 55,500 bytes with a 200 OK response, indicating a successful upload.
- **DLP Investigation:**
  - The DLP team performed a deep inspection, including steganography analysis on the images inside Data.zip.
  - **Findings:** The analysis confirmed that **confidential business data was embedded in the image files**, proving the user's claim was false and the data exfiltration was intentional.

## Action Taken

- **User Contact:** The user was contacted for clarification, and the incident was escalated to the DLP and HR teams for deep inspection.
- **DLP Investigation:** A DLP scan was initiated for similar activities and steganography analysis was performed.
- **Blocking:**
  - The destination IP \_\_\_\_\_ was flagged for monitoring.
  - The website category "**File Storage/Sharing**" was escalated to the Security Engineering Team for blocking on the proxy (Task#1209).
- **Escalation:** The case was escalated to the HR and Legal teams for a policy violation.

## Conclusion

- **Classification:** True Positive, Confirmed Data Exfiltration (Insider Threat via Steganography).
- **Impact:** High - Confidential business data was successfully exfiltrated from the corporate network.
- **Corrective Action:** Blocking of file-sharing sites, employee review, and awareness reinforcement.
- **Status:** Closed